

As soon as Jahveh takes back the breath of life, man and beast die;* or, as it is expressed elsewhere, "the spirit returns to God who gave it."† But that spirit does not live on, at all events not independently or individually; if anything remains of a man after his death, it is his shade, which goes down into Sheol,‡ but cannot be held to *live* there, in the true sense of the word.§ The "spirit" must therefore be breathed into that shade—or into the body of which it is the shadow—by Jahveh afresh, if the person is to begin a new life in his entirety. Of itself now it would be far from strange, if the Jews had been led by their own reflections to the notion of such an awakening, not exactly of all the dead without distinction, but of departed Israelites. Let it be taken into consideration, however, that the hope of a resurrection from the dead also existed among the Persians, and is held with high probability to be an original element of Zarathustra's doctrine.|| Let it also be remembered that it is found in the book of Daniel, side by side with a partition of history into four periods, followed by the Messianic age, which displays great resemblance to the idea which the Persians formed of the course of the development of the world.¶ Does it not become extremely probable, therefore, that Parseeism was not entirely foreign to the rise and the first growth of the Jewish dogma? Must we not also assume here, that the germs which lay hidden in Judaism were fertilized by contact with a religion in which they had arrived at maturity?

If I have succeeded in sketching the line of thought which ended in the enrichment of Judaism with the ideas of which we have here treated, the reader will no longer wonder at the admission of these foreign elements; he will rather think it natural that the Jewish religion proved susceptible to the

* Ps. civ. 29.

† Ecces. xii. 7.

‡ Consider such passages as Gen. xxxvii. 35 ; 1 Sam. xxviii. 19 ; 2 Sam. xii. 23.

§ Comp. Vol. I. pp. 64, sq.

|| Comp. Tiele, l. c., pp. 250, seq., and especially p. 256.

¶ See on this subject Chapter X.